

Laptop Issue Guide

Northgate Group — IT Service Desk Manual | Version 3.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: IT Operations

1. Scope

This guide covers hardware faults on company-issued laptops: power and charging problems, display problems, keyboard and pointing device faults, and overheating. It lists the fault codes used by the service desk, the checks an employee should complete before raising a ticket, the escalation path, and how to request a loaner device. Software installation and licensing are covered by the Software Access Guide. Wireless and VPN problems are covered by the Network Connectivity Guide.

2. Before Raising a Ticket

Completing these checks resolves a large share of reported faults and speeds up diagnosis for the rest. Record what you tried in the ticket description.

- Restart the laptop fully rather than closing the lid; a sleep and wake cycle does not clear most faults.
- Disconnect all peripherals and the docking station, then test the fault again on the laptop alone.
- Check that the power adapter light is lit and that the adapter is connected to a wall socket rather than a monitor or hub.
- Note the exact wording of any error message, and the fault code if one is displayed.
- Check whether the fault happens on battery power, on mains power, or both.

3. Common Fault Codes

The service desk uses the following fault codes. Enter the code in the fault code field when raising a hardware issue ticket. If no code is displayed, leave the field empty and describe the symptom instead.

- E-11 — Battery not charging. The adapter is detected but the charge level does not rise. Usually an adapter or battery health fault.
- E-14 — No power at all. No lights and no fan noise when the power button is held. Usually an adapter, socket or mainboard fault.
- E-22 — No display output. The laptop powers on but the internal screen stays black. Test with an external monitor to isolate the panel.
- E-27 — Screen flickering or intermittent display. Most often a graphics driver fault; occasionally a loose display cable.
- E-31 — Keyboard unresponsive, in whole or in part. Test with an external USB keyboard to isolate the built-in keyboard.
- E-33 — Touchpad or pointing device not responding or jumping.
- E-42 — Docking station not detected. The laptop does not enumerate the dock, so monitors, network and peripherals on the dock stop working.
- E-55 — Thermal shutdown or persistent overheating. The device powers off under load or the fan runs continuously at full speed.
- E-63 — Storage health warning or SMART failure. Back up immediately and raise a high priority ticket.
- E-70 — Wireless adapter missing or disabled in the operating system.

4. Power and Charging Issues

For fault code E-11, first try a different known-good power adapter and a different wall socket. If the charge level rises with a different adapter, the original adapter is faulty and will be replaced without further diagnosis. If the level still does not rise, the battery is likely at end of life and the laptop will be booked in for a battery replacement.

For fault code E-14, hold the power button for 30 seconds with the adapter disconnected to discharge residual power, then reconnect the adapter and try again. A laptop that remains completely dead after this is booked in for hardware repair and a loaner is issued.

5. Screen Problems

For fault code E-22, connect an external monitor. If the external monitor shows a picture, the internal panel or its cable is faulty and the laptop is booked in for panel replacement. If neither display shows a picture, the fault is on the mainboard or graphics chip and the device is replaced rather than repaired.

For fault code E-27, flickering is most often caused by an out-of-date or corrupted graphics driver. The service desk will push the current driver package and ask the employee to restart. Flickering that persists after a driver reinstall, or that changes when the lid angle is moved, indicates a loose display cable and requires a hardware booking.

6. Keyboard and Pointing Device Faults

For fault code E-31, connect an external USB keyboard. If the external keyboard works, the built-in keyboard is faulty and will be replaced. Individual keys that stick or repeat are often caused by debris and may be resolved on site. Liquid spills must be reported immediately; the laptop should be powered off and not charged until it has been inspected.

For fault code E-33, check whether the touchpad has been disabled by a function key combination before raising a ticket. Erratic pointer movement while charging usually indicates a faulty adapter rather than a faulty touchpad.

7. Escalation Procedure and Response Targets

Raise an IT ticket with the request type Hardware Issue, stating the device type and the fault code. The ticket is triaged by the service desk within four working hours and assigned to an IT administrator.

- High priority: employee is unable to work at all. First response within two working hours, resolution or loaner within one business day.
- Medium priority: employee can work but is significantly impaired. First response within one business day, resolution within three business days.
- Low priority: cosmetic or intermittent fault with a workaround. First response within two business days.
- A ticket with no response inside the target is escalated to the IT administrator on duty, and after a further business day to the IT operations manager.

Fault codes E-55 and E-63 are always treated as high priority regardless of the priority selected by the reporter, because both risk data loss.

8. Loaner Device Requests

A loaner laptop is issued where the assigned device will be unavailable for more than one business day. Request a loaner by adding a comment to the existing hardware ticket rather than raising a separate one. Loaners are collected from the IT desk between 09:00 and 17:00 on presentation of a company identity card.

Loaner devices are issued with the standard software image only. Non-standard applications must be requested separately through the Software Access Guide process. The loaner must be returned within two business days of the repaired device being collected. Data left on a loaner is wiped on return, so save work to the approved network location.

9. Data Backup Before Repair

Any laptop booked in for repair may be reimaged without notice. Before handing over a device, confirm that all work is saved to the approved network location. The service desk does not guarantee recovery of data held only on the local drive, and for fault code E-63 recovery may already be impossible.